Campus Lost & Found Portal

Setup and User Manual

for Windows 10 / 11

No programming knowledge is needed.
Follow the steps in order. Total time: about 20 minutes.

Advanced Java & J2EE mini project

Built with Servlets, JSP, JDBC and an embedded Tomcat server.

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1 What you will do

You will make your own laptop run a small website called **Campus Lost & Found**. The website runs *on your laptop only*; nobody else can see it. You open it in Chrome at the address `http://localhost:8080/`.

There are only five steps:

1. Unzip the project folder.
2. Install **Java 21** (the language the project is written in).
3. Download **Maven** (the tool that builds and starts the project).
4. Double-click `run.bat` to start the website.
5. Open the website in Chrome and use it.

You need: (1) the file `campus-lost-found.zip`, (2) a Windows 10 or 11 laptop, (3) an internet connection (only for the first start), (4) about 1 GB of free disk space.

Two things to know before you begin

- A black window (the *console*) will open and show text. **Leave it open** while you use the website. Closing it switches the website off.
- Red text in that window does not always mean a problem. Only worry if the window closes by itself or the website does not open. See Section 9.

2 Step 1 — Unzip the project

1. Find `campus-lost-found.zip` (usually in **Downloads**).
2. **Right-click** it and choose **Extract All...**
3. Click **Browse** and pick the **Desktop**, then click **Extract**.
4. A folder named `campus-lost-found` appears on your Desktop. Open it. You should see the files `run.bat`, `pom.xml`, `README.md` and a folder called `src`.

Note

Do not just double-click the zip and run files from inside it. Windows will not run them properly from inside a zip. Always **Extract All** first.

3 Step 2 — Install Java 21

Java is the engine that runs the project. You install it once.

1. Open Chrome and go to `https://adoptium.net`.
2. Click the download button, then choose these options:
   - Operating System: **Windows**
   - Architecture: **x64** (almost every laptop; if unsure, choose x64)
   - Package Type: **JDK**
   - Version: **21 – LTS**

   Download the file ending in `.msi`.
3. Double-click the downloaded `.msi` file. Click **Next** on each screen.
4. On the screen named **Custom Setup**, make sure these two items have the disk icon (not a red cross): **Add to PATH** and **Set JAVA_HOME variable**. If one shows a red cross, click it and choose "Will be installed on local hard drive".
5. Click **Install**, accept the Windows prompt, then **Finish**.

Check that it worked

1. Press the Windows key, type `cmd`, press Enter. A black Command Prompt window opens.
2. Type this and press Enter:

```
java -version
```

You should see

A few lines starting with something like `openjdk version "21.0.x"`. The number must begin with **21**.

If you see `'java' is not recognized`, restart the laptop once and try again. If it still fails, repeat the installation and tick **Add to PATH**.

4 Step 3 — Download Maven

Maven is a helper that downloads the libraries and starts the project. There is nothing to install: you only unzip it into the project folder.

1. In Chrome, go to `https://maven.apache.org/download.cgi`.
2. Under **Files**, click the link named **Binary zip archive** (the file name starts with `apache-maven` and ends with `-bin.zip`).
3. When it has downloaded, **right-click** it, choose **Extract All...**, and extract it to Downloads. You get a folder named like `apache-maven-3.9.x`.
4. Open that folder. Inside you will see folders called `bin`, `boot`, `conf`, `lib`.
5. **Rename** the `apache-maven-3.9.x` folder to just `maven` (right-click → Rename).
6. **Move** the `maven` folder *into* the `campus-lost-found` folder on your Desktop (drag and drop, or cut and paste).

Check: this file must exist:
`Desktop\campus-lost-found\maven\bin\mvn.cmd`
If instead you have `maven\apache-maven-3.9.x\bin`, you have one folder too many. Move the inner folder out and rename it `maven`.

5 Step 4 — Start the website

1. Open the `campus-lost-found` folder on the Desktop.
2. **Double-click** `run.bat`.
3. If Windows shows a blue "Windows protected your PC" box, click **More info** and then **Run anyway**. The file is just a text list of commands.
4. A black window opens and starts printing lines. **The first time, this takes 2 to 5 minutes** because it downloads libraries. Be patient; the lines keep moving.
5. If Windows Firewall asks whether to allow Java, click **Allow access** (it only runs on your laptop).

You should see

Near the end of the text you will see:

```
Database ready
====================================
Campus Lost & Found is running
Open:  http://localhost:8080/
Demo login:  demo@campus.edu / demo123
====================================
```

That means the website is on. **Do not close this black window.**

6 Step 5 — Open the website

1. Open **Chrome**.
2. Click the address bar at the top, type `localhost:8080`, and press Enter.
3. You land on the **Login** page. That is correct; the site always opens at login.

Ready-made accounts (same password for both):
`demo@campus.edu` and `priya@campus.edu` — password `demo123`

7 Using the website

Create your own account

Click **Sign up**. Enter your name, e-mail, a phone number (optional), and a password of at least 6 characters (type it twice). Then log in.

The top menu

After login you see: **Home**, **Browse**, **Post**, **My items**, **Logout**.

- **Home** — shows how many items are lost, found and reunited, and the newest reports.
- **Browse** — all reports. Use the search box and the filters (Lost / Found, category, open / resolved) to narrow them down.
- **Post** — report something. Choose *Lost* or *Found*, give a title, category, place and date. Keep one detail of the description secret so you can check the real owner

later.

- **My items** — your own reports, any claims waiting for your decision, and the messages you have sent.

If you found something that someone lost (claiming)

1. Open the item from **Browse**.
2. Write a short message (for example, describe a detail only the owner knows) and click **Send**.
3. Your message shows as **PENDING** in **My items** until the owner decides.
4. If the owner **Approves**, you can see their contact details on the item page.

If you posted an item (deciding on claims)

1. Open **My items**. A note such as "1 waiting" means someone sent a message.
2. Open the item. You see the sender's message and two buttons: **Approve** and **Reject**.
3. **Approve** shares your contact details with that person and marks the item resolved. **Reject** keeps the item open.
4. You can also click **Mark as resolved** yourself, or **Delete** to remove your report.

Log out

Click **Logout** at the top right when you are done.

8 Stopping and starting again

- **To stop:** click the black window and press Ctrl + C (or just close the window).
- **To start again:** double-click `run.bat`. It is much faster now (under a minute).
- Your accounts and items are **saved** between runs.

Start from a clean slate

Stop the website first. Then open File Explorer and go to your user folder (`C:\Users\`*`your-name`*). Delete the folder `campus-lostfound-data`. The next start recreates the two demo accounts and six sample items.

9 Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
"Java was not found" when you double-click `run.bat`	Do Step 2 again, then **restart the laptop**. Check with `java -version`.
`'mvn' is not recognized` or the window closes at once	The `maven` folder is in the wrong place. Re-check Step 3: `campus-lost-found\maven\bin\mvn.cmd` must exist.
Error about `JAVA_HOME`	Reinstall Java and tick **Set JAVA_HOME variable**, then restart the laptop.
Lots of "Downloading…" lines	Normal on the first run. Wait. If it stops with a network error, check your internet and double-click `run.bat` again.
`Address already in use` or "port 8080"	Another program uses that port, or the website is already running in another black window. Close all black windows and try again.
Chrome says "This site can't be reached"	The black window is closed or still starting. Wait for "is running", then press F5 in Chrome.
A page shows "Page not found"	You typed a wrong address. Go to `localhost:8080`.
Strange old data on the site	Do the clean slate steps in Section 8.

If nothing works: take a photo or screenshot of the red error text in the black window and send it to the person who gave you this project. That text almost always contains the exact reason.

10 Quick reference

Task	How
Start the website	Double-click `run.bat`
Website address	`http://localhost:8080/`
Ready-made login	`demo@campus.edu` / `demo123`
Second ready-made login	`priya@campus.edu` / `demo123`
Stop the website	Ctrl + C in the black window
Reset all data	Delete `C:\Users\your-name\campus-lostfound-data`